

TOTO COUNCIL OF ELDERS

Nasarawa Local Government Area, Nasarawa State, Federal Republic of Nigeria

P.O. Box 47, Toto Ward Post Office, Nasarawa LGA, Nasarawa State

Email: toto_council_of_elders@gmail.com

Ref: NSW-PHASE1-S15-OBJ-20260925

Date: 2026-09-25

To:

Mrs. Chioma Ndukwe

Community Engagement Coordinator

TelcoNG NetPlan

Plot 274 Adetokunbo Ademola Crescent, Wuse II, Abuja, FCT

Subject: Community Objection to Proposed Cell Site at NSW-PHASE1-S15 (Nasarawa LGA, Toto Ward)

Dear Mrs. Ndukwe,

We write on behalf of the Toto Council of Elders, the formally recognised traditional council of Toto Ward, Nasarawa Local Government Area. The Council comprises seven elders representing the seven principal lineages of Toto, under the chairmanship of His Royal Highness Chief Patrick Audu, the Onye-Toto (literally, "the one of Toto"), the highest traditional title in the ward.

We received notice from TelcoNG NetPlan's field acquisition team on Wednesday September 17, 2026, of the proposed cell site at NSW-PHASE1-S15. We wish to register the Council's formal objection to the proposal in its current form. The Council's specific concerns are detailed below, and we trust that TelcoNG NetPlan will engage in good faith to address each one.

On a procedural matter, the Council notes that the field acquisition team's September 17 site visit was conducted on a Wednesday, the day when most of the Council's members are at their places of work in Nasarawa Town or Lafia. The Council respectfully requests that any future consultations be scheduled for Friday afternoons or Saturday mornings, when the Council can convene in full.

Our specific concerns are as follows:

1. Traditional title and consultation. The proposed site falls within land traditionally administered by the Toto Council of Elders under the chairmanship of Chief Patrick Audu. The Onye-Toto title has been held by the Audu lineage since 1872 and carries with it the responsibility for the disposition of community land. No site construction on Toto land may proceed without the Council's deliberation and the Chief's consent.

2. Burial-ground proximity. The proposed site sits within 60 metres of the Toto ancestral burial ground, which is an active site of veneration for the seven lineages of the ward. The Council cannot consent to construction at the proposed location and respectfully requests that TelcoNG NetPlan consider an alternative location at least 250 metres from the burial ground boundary. We have identified two alternative parcels that would meet this criterion and we are prepared to discuss them.

3. Soil disturbance and environmental remediation. The Toto soil in the proposed location is shallow and rocky. Excavation will displace significant quantities of topsoil that the community uses for compound gardens. The Council requests that TelcoNG NetPlan commit, in writing, to restoring or replacing any displaced topsoil at TelcoNG NetPlan's cost, and that such commitment be enforceable by the Council should restoration not occur.

We respectfully request a community consultation meeting at the Toto town hall on Saturday, October 17, 2026, at 9:00 AM to discuss these matters in full. We invite Mrs. Ndukwe and any colleagues at TelcoNG NetPlan deemed relevant to attend. We will arrange refreshments and the customary courtesies for our guests.

The seven lineages of Toto have sat together on this matter. The two alternative parcels we have identified are at the Council's disposal for inspection at any time. Until the burial-ground and topsoil questions have been answered to the satisfaction of the elders, the proposed location cannot proceed. The Council awaits TelcoNG NetPlan's reply.

Yours faithfully,

HRH Chief Patrick Audu

Onye-Toto; Chairman, Toto Council of Elders

For and on behalf of the Toto Council of Elders

cc: Hon. Chairman, Nasarawa LGA; District Head, Toto Ward; Federal Ministry of Communications and Digital Economy